

FINISHING TECHNIQUES

How to Block a Crochet Project (And When You Actually Need To)

What blocking does, the three common methods, and how to tell whether your project actually needs it.

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Blocking is the step most beginner tutorials skip, and most finished projects would look better for. It's the process of dampening a finished piece and reshaping it flat while it dries, which relaxes uneven tension, straightens curled edges, and can flatten stitches into a neater, more even fabric.

When blocking actually helps

Blocking is worth doing for:

- Granny squares before joining them — makes edges straighter and squares more uniform in size, covered in our [granny square tutorial](#).
- Garment pieces before seaming, so panels lie flat and match up correctly.
- Lace or open-stitch patterns, where blocking opens up the stitch pattern and makes it visible.
- Curled edges on single crochet pieces — also addressed in our [common mistakes guide](#).

It's rarely worth it for amigurumi (stuffing already holds the shape) or heavily textured stitches, where flattening can actually hide the texture you were trying to show.

Three common methods

MOST COMMON

Wet blocking

Submerge the piece in cool water until fully damp, gently squeeze out excess (don't wring), then pin it flat to the finished dimensions on a blocking mat or towel. Leave to dry completely before unpinning. Works best on natural fibres like wool and cotton.

FASTEST

Spray blocking

Pin the piece to shape first, then mist it with water from a spray bottle until damp, rather than fully submerging it. Gentler and faster than wet blocking, and a reasonable middle ground for pieces you don't want to fully soak.

FOR ACRYLIC YARN

Steam blocking

Hold a steamer or iron on a steam setting a few centimetres above the pinned piece — never touch the iron directly to the fabric. This is the method that

actually works on acrylic, since acrylic fibres respond to heat rather than water. Go slowly and check often; too much heat can flatten stitches permanently.

Table: which method for which yarn

FIBRE	BEST METHOD
Wool	Wet or spray blocking
Cotton	Wet or spray blocking
Acrylic	Steam blocking (careful, low heat)
Blends	Test on a swatch first — behaviour depends on the dominant fibre

Frequently asked questions

What does blocking actually do to a crochet project?

Blocking dampens the fibres and lets you reshape and flatten the piece as it dries, which relaxes uneven tension, straightens curled edges, and can adjust the finished dimensions slightly.

Do all yarn fibres block the same way?

No. Natural fibres like wool and cotton hold a blocked shape well. Acrylic yarn barely responds to wet blocking and needs steam blocking instead, done carefully, since heat can flatten or damage the stitches if overdone.

Does every crochet project need to be blocked?

No. Amigurumi and most toys are never blocked. Blocking mainly helps flat pieces like garment panels, blankets, and granny squares, where an even, flat finish matters for the final look or for joining pieces together.

Written by Emily Hartwell

Emily has been crocheting for over a decade, ever since her grandmother taught her the basics one summer. She started CrochetGuides to write the clear, honest, beginner-friendly instructions she wishes she'd had when she was learning — the ones that actually work the first time.